



THE ULTIMATE WORKING HOLIDAY GUIDE TO AUSTRALIA

A NON BULLSHIT APPROACH ON HOW TO SUCCEED AS A
BACKPACKER IN AUSTRALIA



A Systematic Guide for Securing a Job — Everything Discussed from Farming, Construction, Mining and Oil &
Gas

From Backpacker to \$200K Mining Professional — A 13-Year Journey

🔥 PRO HACK: Get Your Tickets REIMBURSED!

Before spending thousands on tickets, read this — you could save up to \$3,000!

🇦🇺 Construction Training Fund — Your Secret Weapon

One of the biggest mistakes backpackers make is paying full price for their tickets. What many don't know is that **state-funded Construction Training Funds** exist to subsidize your training costs!

💡 Real Savings Example:

Intermediate Rigging Course: \$1,500 → After subsidy: ~\$500-800

Working at Heights + Confined Space: \$600 → After subsidy: ~\$200-300

Total potential savings: Up to \$3,000 per year!

What is the Construction Training Fund?

Each Australian state has a training fund or authority that provides subsidies for construction and mining-related training. These funds collect levies from construction projects and redistribute them as training subsidies for workers in the industry.

How to Get Your Tickets Reimbursed

- 1 Get Your CITB/Training Number (FREE)**
Apply online through your state's training authority. Takes 5-10 minutes. No cost.
- 2 Choose an Approved Training Provider**
Ensure your RTO is registered with the training fund. Most major providers are.
- 3 Provide Your Number at Enrollment**
Give your CITB number when booking your course. Critical step!
- 4 Subsidy Applied Automatically**
The discount is applied directly — you pay the reduced rate upfront.

State Training Authorities

State	Authority	Website
South Australia	CITB	citb.org.au
Western Australia	Jobs and Skills WA	jobsandskills.wa.gov.au
Queensland	Construction Skills QLD	csq.org.au
New South Wales	Training Services NSW	training.nsw.gov.au
Victoria	Skills Victoria	skills.vic.gov.au

Tickets Eligible for Subsidies

- **High Risk Work Licences:** Rigging, Scaffolding, Forklift, Dogging
- **Safety Tickets:** Working at Heights, Confined Space, EWP
- **Trade Courses:** Welding certifications, First Aid, Traffic Control
- **Mining Inductions:** Standard 11 (some states)

⚠ Important Tips:

- Apply for your training number **BEFORE** booking courses
- Not all RTOs participate — confirm before enrolling
- Keep receipts even if subsidy is applied (for tax purposes)
- Some subsidies require you to be working in construction

 My Tickets & Certifications

Personal information redacted for privacy

 Job Tier Color-Coding System

 GREEN: Entry-Level Jobs \$20-35/hr — Hospitality, Farm Work
 YELLOW: Mid-Tier Jobs \$45-65/hr — Mining Labourer, Rigging
 BROWN: Trade Jobs \$55-80/hr — Boilermaker, Fitter
 BLUE: Mining & Senior Roles \$65-110+ /hr — Operators, Specialists

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Glossary of Terms

Essential terminology for working in Australian construction, mining, and trades

FIFO

Fly-In Fly-Out work arrangement where workers fly to remote sites for set rosters

DIDO

Drive-In Drive-Out — similar to FIFO but workers drive instead of fly

RTO

Registered Training Organization — accredited training provider

HRW

High Risk Work Licence — nationally recognized credential for dangerous work

VOC

Verification of Competency — site-specific equipment assessment

Standard 11

Underground mining general induction certificate

EWP

Elevated Work Platform — scissor lifts, boom lifts

RPL

Recognition of Prior Learning — converting experience to qualifications

White Card

General construction induction card required for all sites

Shutdown

Intensive maintenance period at mines/plants requiring many workers

BOSIET

Basic Offshore Safety Induction & Emergency Training for oil & gas

MSIC

Maritime Security Identification Card for offshore work

AS1796

Australian welding certification standard

CITB

Construction Industry Training Board — provides training subsidies

Confined Space

Enclosed/partially enclosed space not designed for continuous occupancy

Confined Space Sentry Officer

Person monitoring workers in confined spaces, maintaining communication

Gas Testing

Testing atmosphere in confined spaces for oxygen, toxic & flammable gases

Spotters

Safety personnel who monitor workers at heights or near hazards

Working at Heights

Work where a person could fall and injure themselves (typically 2m+)

Rope Access

Industrial technique using ropes to access difficult locations

IRATA

Industrial Rope Access Trade Association — international rope certification

TIG/MIG Welding

Tungsten/Metal Inert Gas welding processes

Dogging

Entry-level rigging — directing crane operators, slinging loads

Roustabout

Entry-level general labourer on offshore oil/gas platforms

Foreword

This guide provides maximum value for those pursuing working holiday opportunities in Australia. Based on 13+ years of personal experience, it covers farming, construction, hospitality, and mining sectors — with recommendations tailored to your work history, intended stay duration, and budget.

"Wise people learn from other people's mistakes. I encourage you to learn from mine so you can avoid unnecessary suffering and bad financial decisions."

Part 1: Essential Foundations

Understanding Australian Working Holiday Visas

Visa Type	Subclass	Eligible Countries
Working Holiday visa	417	UK, Ireland, Canada, Germany, France, others
Work and Holiday visa	462	USA, Argentina, Chile, Indonesia, Vietnam, others

Basic Requirements

- Age: 18-30 years (some nationalities up to 35)
- Eligible passport with no dependent children
- Minimum funds: AUD \$5,000
- Must be outside Australia when applying for first visa
- Meet health and character requirements

Application Process

1. Create an ImmiAccount through the Australian Government immigration website
2. Start new visa application and select correct subclass
3. Fill in personal details, passport info, travel history
4. Upload documents (passport copy; 462 may need education proof)
5. Pay application fee — AUD \$635
6. Wait for decision — many approved within minutes

Extending Your Stay:

- Second visa: Complete 3 months of specified work in regional areas
- Third visa: Complete 6 months of specified work on your second visa
- Total potential stay: Up to 3 years

Tax File Number (TFN)

Apply online through the ATO website once you arrive in Australia with a valid visa (417, 462, student, etc.).

Why a Car is Your Best Investment

- Public transport in Australia is limited and unreliable
- Cars hold their value well
- Avoid expensive hostel traps (\$300+/week for shared dorms)
- One week without work can cost \$2,000+ AUD

Budget Range	Vehicle Options
\$2,000-\$7,000	Great Wall 4x4, Honda CR-V, Mitsubishi ASX, RAV4
\$8,000-\$15,000	Pajero, Kluger, Pathfinder, Navara/Triton utes
\$15,000+	Toyota Hilux, Land Cruiser Prado

Success Story: "I bought an 80-series Landcruiser at 377,000 km for \$11,000 and sold it at 417,000 km for \$14,000."

Understanding Recruitment Agencies

Used for construction, mining, and farming. Agency charges client more than they pay you (margin = profit). Example: Agency charges \$70/hr, pays you \$40/hr = \$30/hr profit.

▲ Key Points: You'll mostly work on casual basis with no paid sick days or holiday pay. Avoid Gumtree jobs — often cash-in-hand with no insurance.

Mastering the Job Search

"Think of sending your resume like planting a seed. Then water it by calling when you don't hear back. Call at least once a week. Hearing back can take up to 3 months."

How to Call Recruitment Agencies

1. Be calm — don't rush or sound desperate
2. Start with small talk — "Hey, how are you going?"
3. Be specific — state your name and exact job you want
4. Follow up — this sets you apart from others

Understanding FIFO (Fly-In Fly-Out)

What is FIFO?

FIFO is a work arrangement common in Australian mining. Workers fly from their home city to a remote mine site, work a set roster (typically 2 weeks on, 1 week off), then fly home.

What's Included:

- ✈ Flights: Employer pays all flights
- 🏠 Accommodation: Purpose-built mining camps — FREE
- 🍽 Meals: All meals provided in camp mess — FREE
- 🚌 Transport: Bus transfers — FREE
- 🏊 Facilities: Gym, recreation room, WiFi, laundry

The Savings Advantage of Living on Camp

Why FIFO = Maximum Savings: While on camp, you have virtually ZERO living expenses!

Expense	City Living	FIFO Camp
Rent/Accommodation	\$1,600-\$2,500	\$0
Food/Groceries	\$600-\$1,000	\$0
Utilities	\$200-\$400	\$0
Transport/Fuel	\$300-\$600	\$0
TOTAL	\$2,700-\$4,500	\$0!

Real Example: Mining Labourer earning \$48/hr on a 2:1 roster:
Weekly earnings on site: ~\$4,000+ (with overtime)
Monthly gross: ~\$8,000-\$10,000
Potential annual savings: \$80,000-\$100,000+

Common FIFO Rosters

Roster	Days On	Days Off	Best For
2:1	14	7	Most common, good balance
8:6	8	6	Better work-life balance
4:3	4	3	DIDO roles
15:13	15	13	Senior/specialist roles

1.1 Hospitality — Housekeeping & Cleaning

Entry-level cleaning and housekeeping roles in hotels, hostels, and resorts.

Pay: \$22-\$28/hr | Weekly: \$880-\$1,120 | Annual: \$45,000-\$58,000

Requirement	Cost	Notes
None mandatory	\$0	Basic entry-level position
RSA (optional)	\$60-\$150	Beneficial if role includes bar areas

 **Warning:** Avoid businesses offering unpaid trial days — this is illegal in Australia!

1.2 Hospitality — Restaurant & Café Work

Food service roles including waiting tables, food prep, barista work, and kitchen hand duties.

Pay: \$23-\$30/hr (casual) | Weekly: \$920-\$1,200 | Annual: \$48,000-\$62,000

Requirement	Cost	Validity
RSA (Responsible Service of Alcohol)	\$60-\$150	State-specific, 3-5 years
Food Safety Certificate	\$80-\$150	Varies by state

TIER 2

Seasonal Farm Work (\$25-\$40/hour)

2.1 Tractor Driving / Farm Hand ✓ RECOMMENDED

Operating tractors with GPS auto-steer systems for seeding, harvesting, and general farm operations.

Pay: \$28-\$40/hr | Weekly (50-60 hrs): \$1,400-\$2,400 | Seasonal: \$15,000-\$20,000+ saved

Real Example: "I saved around \$17,000 in four months driving a tractor."

Requirement	Cost	Notes
None required	\$0	Farmland is private — no licenses needed
First Aid (optional)	\$100-\$150	Some farms prefer this

Seeding Seasons:

Crop Type	Season	Regions
Winter crops	April-June	WA, SA, VIC, NSW
Summer crops	Sept-Dec	Northern NSW, QLD

Key Benefits: ✓ Food & accommodation usually supplied | ✓ Counts towards 88 days for visa | ✓ No experience necessary | ✓ No licenses needed

2.2 Fruit Picking ✗ NOT RECOMMENDED

⚠ AVOID:

- Paid by piece rate — often \$15-\$25/hour effective
- "Working hostels" overcharge for accommodation
- Exposure to pesticides causing rashes
- Inconsistent work (sent home when it rains)

TIER 3

Construction Work (\$35-\$50/hour)

3.1 Construction Labourer

General labouring including material handling, site cleanup, basic trades assistance, and operating small equipment.

Pay: \$35-\$45/hr | Daily: \$350-\$450 | Weekly: \$1,750-\$2,250 | Annual: \$85,000-\$115,000

Real Example: "My French friends earned \$400 a day each for a couple of months in construction outside the city."

Required Tickets:

Requirement	Cost	Validity
White Card (Construction Induction)	\$80-\$150	No expiry
Standard Driver's License	—	Varies
Manual Handling Certificate	\$80-\$120	3 years

Optional But Valuable:

Ticket	Cost	Benefit
Working at Heights	\$200-\$350	More job opportunities
EWP (Elevated Work Platform)	\$250-\$400	Operate scissor/boom lifts
Forklift License (LF)	\$250-\$400	Warehouse/site work

3.2 Traffic Controller

Pay: \$35-\$50/hr | Daily: \$350-\$500 | Weekly: \$1,750-\$2,500 | Annual: \$80,000-\$120,000



Traffic controllers managing site access — a popular entry point into construction

Requirement	Cost	Validity
Traffic Controller Ticket	\$250-\$400	3 years
White Card	\$80-\$150	No expiry
First Aid Certificate	\$100-\$150	3 years



Rigging & Scaffolding Careers (\$45-\$65/hour)

High-demand mid-tier roles across mining, construction, and oil & gas sectors.

Rigging Career Levels

Riggers safely move heavy loads using cranes, hoists, and lifting equipment.

Level	Description	Pay
Dogging	Entry-level: directing crane operators, loads up to 20t	\$40-\$50/hr
Basic Rigging	Equipment setup, structural steel erection	\$45-\$55/hr
Intermediate	Multi-crane lifts, complex load calculations	\$55-\$65/hr
Advanced	Heavy machinery, structures over 20t	\$60-\$75/hr

Scaffolding Career Levels

Scaffolders erect, alter, and dismantle temporary work platforms.

Level	Description	Pay
Basic	Prefab modular scaffolds, restricted heights	\$40-\$50/hr
Intermediate	Modular and tube scaffolds	\$50-\$60/hr
Advanced	Hung/suspended scaffolds, complex structures	\$55-\$70/hr

 Annual Potential:

Intermediate Rigger (FIFO): \$120,000-\$150,000/year

Advanced Scaffolders (Shutdown): \$130,000-\$160,000/year

Career Progression:

- 1 Start:** Trade Assistant/Labourer — Get White Card
- 2 Get Licensed:** Basic/Intermediate HRW Licence (1-2 weeks)
- 3 Gain Experience:** 6-12 months site experience
- 4 Advanced:** Mining FIFO or Shutdown Work — \$60-\$75/hr

📄 High Risk Work Licences (HRW)

Nationally recognized credentials required by law for specific high-risk activities.

Types of HRW Licences

Class	Description	Cost	Duration
DG	Dogging	\$800-\$1,200	3-5 days
RB	Basic Rigging	\$1,000-\$1,500	5 days
RI	Intermediate Rigging	\$1,200-\$1,800	5-7 days
RA	Advanced Rigging	\$1,500-\$2,500	5-7 days
SB	Basic Scaffolding	\$800-\$1,200	3-5 days
SI	Intermediate Scaffolding	\$1,000-\$1,500	5 days
LF	Forklift	\$250-\$400	1-2 days
WP	Boom-type EWP	\$300-\$500	1-2 days

Why WA is Best for Getting Licensed:

- ✔ More training providers = competitive prices
- ✔ Mining companies often pay for tickets once employed
- ✔ Immediate job opportunities
- ✔ Construction Training Fund may reimburse costs

Process to Get HRW Licence:

1. Choose an RTO (TAFE WA, Nara Training, iCollege)
2. Complete training course (theory + practical)
3. Pass the assessment
4. Apply to WorkSafe WA with your NOA
5. Receive licence card — valid 5 years Australia-wide

Training Providers in WA:

Provider	Location	Speciality
TAFE WA	Perth, Joondalup	Full range of HRW courses
Nara Training	Perth, Kalgoorlie	Mining-focused
iCollege	Perth	Construction tickets
ERGT Australia	Perth	Oil & gas, mining safety

TIER 4

Mining Labourer & Trade Assistant (\$48-\$55/hour)

Mining Labourer / Trade Assistant

General support work including ventilation maintenance, pipe installation, equipment moving, ground support, and assisting tradespeople.

Pay: \$48-\$55/hr (nights up to \$60+/hr) | Daily: \$576-\$660 | Roster: 2:1
Annual: \$110,000-\$140,000

Required Tickets:

Requirement	Cost	Validity
Standard 11 (Underground Induction)	\$300-\$500	5 years
Working at Heights	\$200-\$350	2-5 years
Confined Space	\$250-\$400	2-5 years
First Aid	\$100-\$150	3 years
Driver's License (C Class)	—	—

 Why Western Australia for Mining

134,009

Mining Jobs in WA

47%

of AU Mining Workforce

11,065

New Workers by 2029

\$200K+

Top Earner Potential

Why WA Dominates:

- 🏆 Iron Ore Capital: 65,496 FTE jobs in Pilbara
- 🏆 Gold Rush: 35,672 FTE jobs in Goldfields
- 📈 40% of Australia's resource workforce growth
- 🌟 Critical skills shortage = easier to get hired
- ➔ Perth is the FIFO gateway

🔒 Working at Heights & Confined Spaces

Essential certifications for Trade Assistants in Mining & Construction

📌 Working at Heights — Why It's Essential

Working at heights certification is **mandatory for any work above 2 meters** in Australian mining and construction. Due to strict safety regulations, falls from height are one of the most common causes of workplace fatalities.



Scaffolding work in mining operations



Professional scaffold erection

Why This Certification is Essential:

- **Legal Requirement:** Cannot work on elevated platforms without certification
- **Insurance Coverage:** Uncertified work voids insurance
- **Higher Pay:** Opens doors to scaffolding, rigging, and rope access roles
- **Site Access:** Most mine sites require this ticket for ALL workers

🔍 SPOTTERS on Mine Sites

Due to Australia's strict safety regulations, it's common for mine sites to employ **SPOTTERS** — dedicated safety personnel who monitor workers at heights. Their role includes:

- Observing workers for signs of fatigue or unsafe behavior
- Monitoring anchor points and fall arrest systems
- Coordinating emergency response if a fall occurs
- Ensuring exclusion zones are maintained below work areas

Working at Heights Requirements:

Certification	Cost	Duration	Validity
Working at Heights	\$200-\$350	1 day	2-5 years
EWP (Boom/Scissor Lift)	\$250-\$400	1-2 days	5 years
Basic Scaffolding (SB)	\$800-\$1,200	3-5 days	5 years

🚧 Confined Spaces — Critical for Mining

Confined space work is one of the **highest-risk activities** in mining. A confined space is any enclosed or partially enclosed space not designed for continuous human occupancy, with limited entry/exit points and potential for hazardous atmospheres.



Worker entering confined space with safety equipment



Industrial confined space operations

Why Confined Spaces Work is Essential in Mining:

- **Underground Infrastructure:** Tanks, silos, pits, shafts, and tunnels all require certified workers
- **Maintenance Critical:** Regular inspections of vessels, pipes, and storage containers
- **High Demand:** Every shutdown requires confined space certified workers
- **Premium Pay:** Confined space work often pays 10-20% more

⚠ The Dangers of Confined Spaces:

- Oxygen deficiency (below 19.5%) — can cause unconsciousness in seconds
- Toxic gases (H2S, CO, methane) — often undetectable without equipment
- Engulfment hazards (grain, sand, liquids)
- Limited rescue access — specialized equipment required

🔧 Gas Testing — The Most Critical Skill

Before ANY confined space entry, the atmosphere must be tested. This is non-negotiable.

Gas	Safe Level	Danger
Oxygen (O2)	19.5%-23.5%	Below 19.5% = asphyxiation risk
Hydrogen Sulfide (H2S)	<10 ppm	Highly toxic, "rotten egg" smell
Carbon Monoxide (CO)	<25 ppm	Odorless, causes confusion/death
Lower Explosive Limit (LEL)	<10%	Explosion/fire risk

Gas Testing Process:

1. Test BEFORE entry — never assume the atmosphere is safe
2. Test at multiple levels (top, middle, bottom) — gases stratify
3. Continuous monitoring during work
4. Calibrate equipment daily

NEW ROLE: Confined Space Sentry Officer

The **Confined Space Sentry Officer** (also called Standby Person or Hole Watch) is a critical safety role that monitors workers inside confined spaces.



Confined Space Sentry Officer maintaining communication with workers below

Role & Responsibilities:

- **Continuous Watch:** Must remain at the entry point at ALL times
- **Communication:** Maintain contact with workers inside (radio, visual, rope signals)
- **Emergency Response:** Initiate rescue procedures if workers become distressed
- **Access Control:** Ensure only authorized personnel enter
- **Monitoring:** Track atmospheric conditions and time limits
- **Documentation:** Log all entries, exits, and atmospheric readings

Why This is a GREAT Entry Role:

- Lower physical demands than entry work
- Same hourly rate as confined space entrants
- Learn rescue procedures and gas testing
- Pathway to supervisor roles
- Always in demand during shutdowns

Requirements to Become a Sentry Officer:

Requirement	Cost	Notes
Confined Space Entry & Monitoring	\$250-\$400	Covers both entry and standby duties
First Aid Certificate	\$100-\$150	Essential for emergency response
Gas Testing Awareness	Included	Part of confined space course
CPR/Low Voltage Rescue	\$80-\$150	Often required on mine sites

▲ Critical Rule: The Sentry Officer must NEVER enter the confined space to attempt rescue. If a worker is in distress, they must immediately raise the alarm and initiate the emergency rescue procedure. Untrained rescuers often become additional victims.

⚡ Shutdown Work

Intensive maintenance periods requiring large numbers of workers for short contracts.

Why Shutdowns are GOLD for Backpackers:

- 💰 Premium Pay: 10-20% higher rates
- 📅 Flexible: 2-6 week contracts
- 🔄 Year-Round: Different mines have different schedules
- 🧠 Experience: Learn from experienced tradespeople

Major WA Mining Regions:

Region	Commodities	Major Employers
Pilbara	Iron Ore	BHP, Rio Tinto, FMG, Roy Hill
Goldfields	Gold, Nickel	Northern Star, Evolution
Mid West	Iron Ore, Gold	Karara Mining, Westgold
South West	Alumina, Lithium	Alcoa, Talison Lithium

Finding Shutdown Work:

- **Agencies:** Programmed, Hays, Chandler Macleod, WorkPac
- **Job Boards:** SEEK, Indeed
- **Direct:** FMS Group, Premium Mechanical Group, Centurion



Trade Careers: Boilermaker & Fitter (\$55-\$80/hour)

The backbone of mining and construction — formal qualifications with exceptional earning potential.

Boilermaker

Fabricating, assembling, and repairing metal structures, tanks, pressure vessels, and heavy equipment.

Pay: \$55-\$80/hr | Daily: \$660-\$960 | Annual (FIFO): \$140,000-\$180,000+

Requirement	How to Get It
Cert III Engineering - Fabrication Trade	Apprenticeship (3-4 yrs) OR RPL
Welding Certifications (AS1796)	TAFE or RTO course
Mine site tickets	Standard 11, Heights, Confined Space

Welding Work in Mining



Precision welding on mining equipment



Rope access welder in mining operations

Fitter / Mechanical Fitter

Installing, maintaining, and repairing machinery and mechanical equipment.

Pay: \$55-\$75/hr | Daily: \$660-\$900 | Annual (FIFO): \$130,000-\$170,000

Requirement	How to Get It
Cert III Engineering - Mechanical Trade	Apprenticeship (3-4 yrs) OR RPL
Hydraulics knowledge	On-the-job or courses
Mine site tickets	Standard 11, Heights, Confined Space

Rope Access — High-Demand Specialty

Industrial rope access technicians use specialized climbing techniques to access difficult locations for inspection, maintenance, and repair work.



IRATA-certified rope access technician



Industrial rope access work

Why Rope Access is Premium Work:

- **Eliminates Scaffolding:** Faster access = cost savings for clients
- **Specialized Skills:** Limited supply of qualified technicians
- **Diverse Industries:** Mining, oil & gas, wind turbines, buildings
- **International Recognition:** IRATA certification valid worldwide

IRATA Level 1: \$45-\$55/hr | Level 2: \$55-\$70/hr | Level 3: \$70-\$90/hr

IRATA Certification Pathway:

Level	Requirements	Cost	Duration
Level 1	Basic fitness, no experience needed	\$2,500-\$3,500	5 days
Level 2	1,000 logged hours as L1	\$2,000-\$2,500	5 days
Level 3	1,000 logged hours as L2	\$2,000-\$2,500	5 days

Machinery Operator

Operating heavy machinery — dump trucks, loaders (CAT 996), excavators on surface or underground mines.

Pay: \$55-\$75/hr | Daily: \$660-\$900 | Roster: 2:1 | Annual: \$130,000-\$170,000

Required Tickets:

Requirement	Cost	Notes
HR License (Heavy Rigid)	\$1,500-\$3,000	Required for site driving
Machinery VOCs	\$400-\$1,000 each	Site-specific assessments
Standard 11 / Site Induction	\$300-\$500	5 years

Common Machinery VOCs:

Equipment	Cost
Articulated Dump Truck (ADT)	\$500-\$1,000
CAT 996 Loader	\$500-\$1,000
Excavator	\$500-\$1,000
Grader	\$500-\$1,000
Water Cart	\$300-\$500

Mineral Process Operator

Safe processing of ore, fault-finding, communication with control room, SAP for maintenance scheduling.

Pay: \$70-\$90/hr | Daily: \$840-\$1,080 | Roster: 15:13
Annual: \$170,000-\$210,000+

Real Example: "I currently work paying close to \$200K per year on a 15-day-on, 13-day-off roster."

Requirements:

- All Tier 4 & 5 tickets
- Process Plant Induction
- SAP/Maintenance Systems knowledge
- Dangerous Goods License (\$200-\$400)
- HR License (unrestricted)

RPL: Fast-Track to Trade Qualified

What is RPL?

RPL converts your existing work experience into a nationally recognized qualification — WITHOUT years of apprenticeship!

Think of it as getting credit for what you already know how to do.

Why RPL is a Game-Changer

- 🕒 **Time:** Get qualified in weeks, not 3-4 years
- 💰 **Pay Boost:** Trade workers earn 30-50% more
- 📈 **Jump:** From \$48/hr (assistant) to \$65+/hr (tradesperson)
- 📜 **Licences:** Required for many contractor licences

How RPL Works:

1. **Free Assessment:** Initial eligibility check
2. **Evidence Collection:** Resume, photos, references, certificates
3. **Assessment:** Qualified assessor reviews against standards
4. **Gap Training:** Short courses if needed
5. **Qualification:** Receive nationally recognized Cert III

Available Through RPL:

Qualification	Experience Needed	Cost
Cert III Fabrication (Boilermaker)	2-3 years	\$2,000-\$4,000
Cert III Mechanical (Fitter)	2-3 years	\$2,000-\$4,000
Cert III Carpentry	2-3 years	\$1,500-\$3,500
Cert III Civil Construction	2-3 years	\$1,500-\$3,500

🔑 **Pro Tip:** If you have trade experience from your home country, RPL can convert it to Australian qualifications — opening doors to much higher-paying roles immediately!

RPL Providers:

- TAFE Queensland — tafeqld.edu.au
- Trade Skills Australia — tradeskillsaustralia.com.au
- Qualify Me! — qualifyme.edu.au
- Gimbal Group — gimbalgroup.com.au

TAFE Courses & Earning Potential

TAFE offers practical, industry-focused training to boost your earning potential.

Welding Courses — High Demand

Course	Duration	Cost	Pay Boost
Intro to Welding	3 days	~\$600	Trade assistant roles
AS1796 Certification	2-10 weeks	\$1,500-\$1,800	+\$5-10/hr
TIG Certification	1-3 weeks	\$765	Premium TIG rates
Cert III Fabrication	12-48 months	\$3,000-\$27,800	Full trade

AS1796 Welding Tickets:

Ticket	Process	Demand
Ticket 1	MMA - Plate	High
Ticket 2	MMA - Pipe	Very High
Ticket 3E/3F	MIG/MAG	High
Ticket 5	TIG - Light gauge	Premium
Ticket 7	TIG - Pipe	Premium

Earning Potential:

- Trade Assistant (no tickets): \$35-45/hr
- Welder with AS1796: \$50-65/hr
- Coded Welder (mining): \$65-85/hr
- **Annual difference: \$30,000-\$50,000+ more!**

Oil & Gas Offshore Pathways

Highest-paying opportunities in Australia — requires specific certifications and significant investment.



Offshore oil rig operations



Workers on offshore platform at sunset

Is Offshore Right for You?

Factor	Consideration
Visa Duration	Need 6+ months to make investment worthwhile
Budget	Minimum \$3,000-5,000 for certifications
Physical Fitness	Demanding, strict medical requirements
Commitment	2-4 weeks offshore at a time

Essential Offshore Tickets:

Certification	Cost	Duration	Validity
BOSIET with CA-EBS	\$2,000-\$2,500	2 days	4 years
MSIC	\$100-\$150	1-2 weeks	5 years
Offshore Medical	\$300-\$500	Same day	2 years
FOET (refresher)	\$800-\$1,200	1 day	4 years

Offshore Career Pathways:

Entry Level:

- Roustabout: General labouring — \$50-65/hr
- Galley Hand: Catering — \$40-55/hr
- Stores/Logistics: Inventory — \$50-60/hr

Experienced:

- Derrickman: Drilling operations — \$65-85/hr
- Crane Operator: Heavy lifting — \$70-90/hr
- Production Tech: Process ops — \$70-95/hr

Senior:

- Driller: Team leader — \$85-120/hr
- OIM: Platform commander — \$150,000-\$300,000/year

Recommendations by Situation

🕒 6-12 months on visa:

Start with onshore mining to build experience first. Offshore companies prefer candidates with Australian work history.

🕒 1-2 years remaining:

Excellent time to invest. Get experience onshore (6 months), then target offshore.

💰 Tight budget:

Focus on mining first — similar pay, lower entry costs. Use mining income to fund offshore tickets later.

Training Provider:

ERGT Australia (Perth) — ergt.edu.au — Premier oil & gas training

Investment Summary — Tickets & Licenses

Starter Package (\$500-\$800)

For: Hospitality, Farming, Entry-level Construction

Ticket	Cost	Opens Jobs In
White Card	\$100	All construction sites
RSA	\$80	Hospitality
First Aid	\$150	All industries
Manual Handling	\$100	All manual work
Total	~\$430	

Construction Package (\$1,500-\$2,500)

For: Construction labouring, traffic control, warehouse

Ticket	Cost
White Card	\$100
Working at Heights	\$300
EWP License	\$350
Forklift License	\$350
Traffic Controller	\$350
First Aid	\$150
Total	~\$1,600

Mining Starter Package (\$3,000-\$5,000)

For: Entry-level mining, trade assistant

Ticket	Cost
Standard 11 Induction	\$450
Working at Heights	\$300
Confined Space	\$350
First Aid	\$150
Manual Handling	\$100
HR License	\$2,000
Total	~\$3,350

Job Progression Roadmap

- 1



TIER 1: Hospitality (\$22-\$28/hr)

Investment: \$0-\$150 | Immediate start
- 2



TIER 2: Farm Work (\$28-\$40/hr)

Investment: \$0 | Get 88 days here!
- 3



TIER 3: Construction (\$35-\$50/hr)

Investment: \$500-\$2,500 | 1-3 months
- 4



TIER 4: Mining Labourer (\$48-\$55/hr)

Investment: \$3,000-\$5,000 | 1-3 months
- 4b



Rigging & Scaffolding (\$45-\$65/hr)

Investment: \$4,000-\$6,000 | 3-6 months experience
- 5



Trade Qualified (\$55-\$80/hr)

Investment: RPL \$2,000-\$4,000 OR Apprenticeship
- 6



TIER 5: Mining Operator (\$55-\$75/hr)

Investment: \$6,000-\$10,000 | 6-12 months experience
- 7



TIER 6: Mining Senior (\$70-\$90+ /hr)

Investment: Ongoing | 2-5+ years experience

POTENTIAL: \$170,000-\$200,000+/year

Australian Work Culture

"Being German, I struggled with the idea of having to be perfect. Australia is different — it really is 'easy going.'
Show willingness to learn, listen, and don't be arrogant."

The Key to Success

Your interpersonal skills matter more than experience for lower-tier jobs. Show willingness to learn, be humble, and demonstrate reliability.

Avoiding Common Mistakes

1. Don't get trapped in hostels — expensive accommodation drains savings
2. Don't travel in large groups — job searching is more effective alone
3. Don't limit yourself geographically — apply Australia-wide
4. Don't buy the cheapest car — repairs can cost more than the vehicle
5. Don't work cash-in-hand — no insurance, no protection
6. Don't accept unpaid trials — it's illegal in Australia

Essential Websites

Resource	URL	Purpose
Seek	seek.com.au	Job listings
Indeed	au.indeed.com	Job listings
Immigration	immi.homeaffairs.gov.au	Visa applications
TFN Application	ato.gov.au	Tax File Number
CITB	citb.org.au	Training subsidies

This guide represents 13+ years of real experience. Follow the journey, learn from these mistakes, and create your own Australian success story.

Document Version: Professional Edition v3.0 | Last Updated: February 2026

Organization: Jobs arranged from lower-paying to higher-paying positions with clear requirements and color-coding